



PATET

Money skills + your real bank data + an AI coach who knows what you're actually spending on.

Plaid IAM partnership briefing · prepared May 2026

Three forces are converging. Patet sits exactly in the middle.

01

AI quality crossed the line

- Frontier LLMs (Claude Sonnet, GPT-4o) can answer real personal-finance questions accurately and on-budget.
- Inference cost has fallen >50% YoY — viable at sub-\$3 MRR.
- Coach-style products (Cleo, Origin) have validated demand.

02

Mint left a vacuum

- Intuit shut Mint down March 2024. ~20M users displaced.
- Premium replacements (Monarch, Copilot) cost \$13-\$15/mo. None ship a curriculum.
- The free-tier hole is wide open below \$5/mo.

03

Gen Z is unbanked on knowledge

- Only 24% of Gen Z feel confident managing money. 36% find finance confusing.
- Gen Z gamified-literacy market: \$0.31B (2025) -> \$1.92B (2034), 22.9% CAGR.
- No incumbent owns this segment with both bank data + curriculum.

A real category, an underserved sub-segment, an obvious wedge.

The category is real, the entry tier is empty.

- Personal-finance software TAM: \$1.08B (2022) -> \$1.59B (2030), 5.1% CAGR. Source: Grand View Research.
- Broader personal-finance-apps market projected \$207B (2026) -> \$507B (2030). Source: Business Research Company.
- Gen Z gamified-literacy subsegment is the fastest-growing slice: 22.9% CAGR to 2034.
- Mint shutdown (Mar 2024) -> ~20M users displaced. Monarch absorbed ~1M (April 2026, \$850M valuation, \$75M Series B).
- Rocket Money grew to 10M+ members post-Mint. Copilot Money grew to 100K+ paying.
- Median competitor Pro tier price: \$12.99/mo. Median annual: ~\$95. Patet enters at \$2.99 / \$6.99.

The gap, in one sentence

No competitor in the US market bundles a structured financial-literacy curriculum, live bank data, and a real LLM coach in a single product priced under \$7/month.

Cleo has personality but no curriculum. Origin has SEC-regulated AI but no lessons and \$13/mo entry. Ramsey has curriculum but no AI or live bank data. YNAB has bank data but no AI, no lessons, and a \$15/mo floor.

What ships today — one screen.

18

modules

121

lessons

36+

screens

EN / ES

languages

Curriculum

- 18 modules · 121 lessons (~2-5 min each)
- 242 quiz cards, 50-question final assessment
- Modules incl. Paycheck, Debt, Saving, Budgeting, Investing, Credit, Student Loans, Mental-Health-of-money
- Spanish parity shipped (LATAM reviewer pass pending)

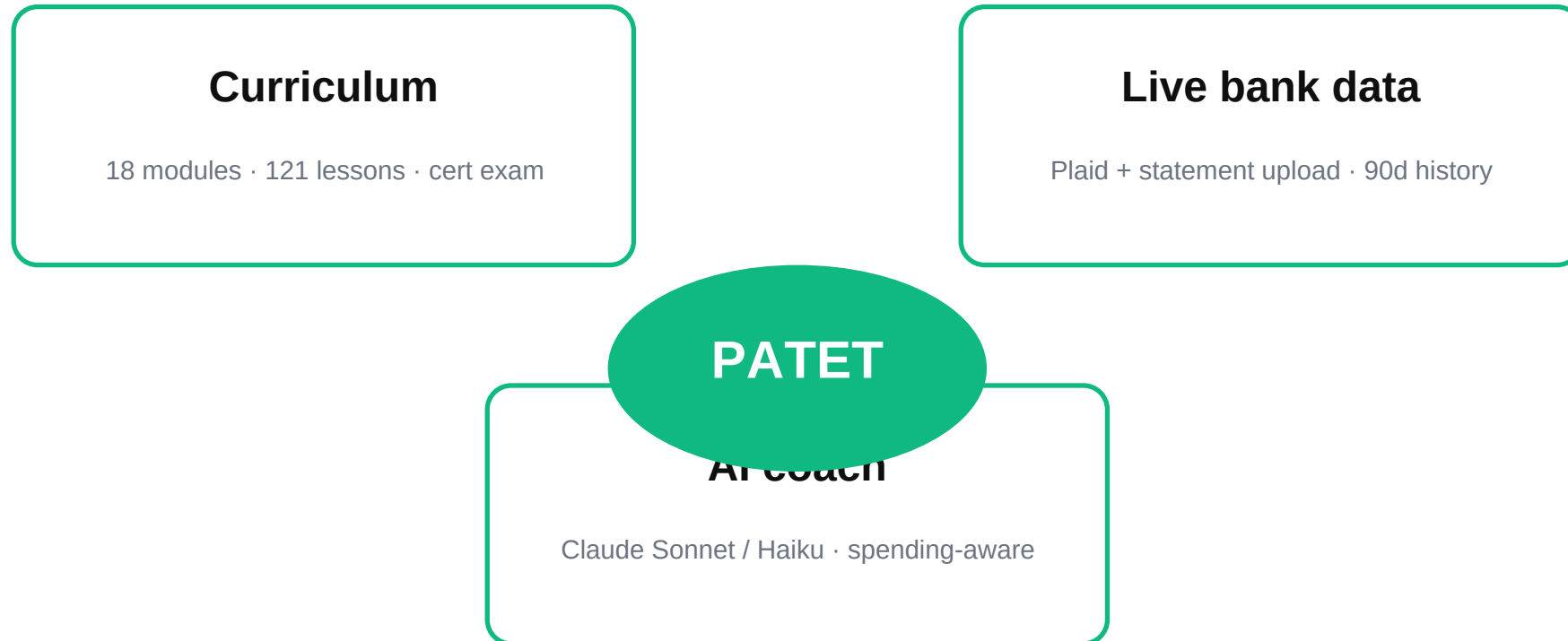
AI coach (Glyphe)

- Claude Sonnet 4.6 (Pro+) + Haiku 4.5 (Free/Pro)
- Knows your 121 lessons + 11 affiliate products + your Plaid spending
- 4 personas unlocked by progress: Older Sibling -> Strategist -> Therapist -> Hype Friend
- Voice in/out · streaming · follow-up chips
- Crisis detection + medical/legal/financial guardrails

Bank data + tools

- Plaid Link (Transactions + Liabilities), encrypted tokens (AES-256-GCM)
- Statement upload — PDF / CSV / Excel, AI-extracted transactions
- 5 calculators, What-If scenarios, Future You, Money Roast, Money IQ, Salary negotiation
- Spending-pattern detection -> ranked lesson recs
- Peer benchmarks (20-user minimum cohort, k-anonymity)

Three layers, no competitor has all three.



Ramsey owns curriculum but has no AI and no real-time bank data. Cleo owns the AI coach but has no curriculum. Monarch / Rocket / Copilot own bank data but ship no lessons and no LLM coach. Patet is the only product at the intersection.

Where everyone sits — and where the gaps are.

Product	Monthly \$	LLM coach	Plaid	Curriculum	Stmt upload	Voice
Patet	\$2.99 / \$6.99	Yes (Sonnet+Haiku)	Yes	Yes (121 lessons)	Yes (PDF/CSV/XLS)	Yes
YNAB	\$14.99	No	Yes	Workshops only	CSV only	No
Rocket	\$7-\$14	No	Yes	No	No	No
Copilot	\$13	Partial (ML)	Yes	No	CSV only	No
Monarch	\$14.99	No	Yes	No	CSV only	No
EveryDollar	\$17.99	No	Premium only	Ramsey FPU video	No	No
Cleo	\$5.99-\$14.99	Yes (multi-model)	Yes	No	No	Limited
Origin	\$12.99	Yes (SEC-reg)	Yes	No	CSV only	No

Patet is the only row that says Yes across LLM coach, Plaid, curriculum, statement upload, and voice — at the lowest price point. Verified May 2026 via vendor pricing pages.

What we ship that nobody else does.

01

Spending-aware AI coach

Claude Sonnet 4.6 with your real Plaid transactions in-context. Not a chatbot — a coach that can say 'you spent \$340 on restaurants this month; here's lesson 4.3.'

03

121-lesson curriculum at \$2.99

Ramsey charges \$79.99/year for curriculum alone. Patet ships 18 modules + 121 lessons in \$2.99/mo Pro — and unlocks an AI tutor that knows the curriculum cold.

05

Money Roast + Future You + Personality

Emotional engagement layer competitors don't ship. Roast = 3-tone spending critique. Future You = life at 30. Personality = 5 archetypes.

07

Crisis detection with text normalization

Unicode + homoglyph + l33tspeak normalization on every coach turn. Routes to 988 / Crisis Text Line / 211.org. NIST AI RMF aligned.

09

Spanish curriculum (LATAM)

All 121 lessons + content surfaces translated to LATAM Spanish. Native reviewer pass pending pre-launch. No major US competitor ships Spanish curriculum.

02

Statement upload, multi-format

PDF, CSV, and Excel bank statements parsed and AI-categorized. Most competitors offer CSV only — or no upload at all.

04

Learn-then-unlock coach personas

Four coach personalities unlock at module milestones (Older Sibling default -> Strategist @5 -> Therapist @10 -> Hype Friend @15). Gamifies completion.

06

Voice in / voice out

Native Web Speech on web; expo-speech on mobile. Full voice-mode conversation. Cleo has voice; no other competitor in the matrix does.

08

Top-of-funnel viral assessment

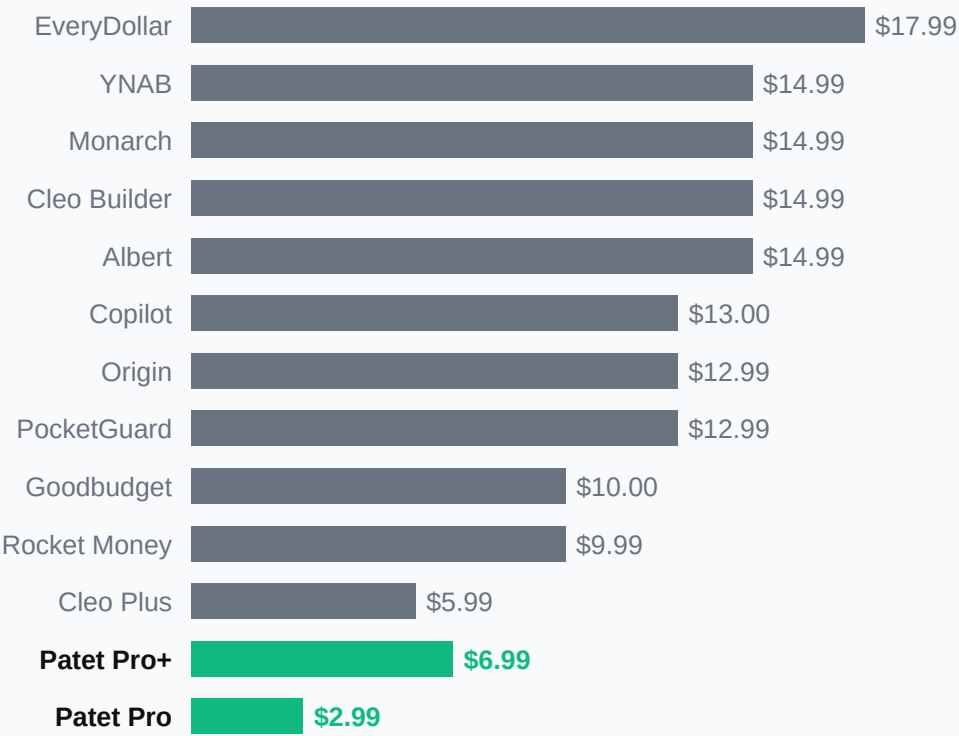
Public Financial IQ quiz at /iq (no auth, dynamic OG share image). Free funnel that converts to registered users.

10

Strict-freemium tier gating

Plaid + statement upload + advanced calculators + scenarios all sit behind \$2.99 Pro. Hard-gated server-side, not trial-and-revoke. Real boundary.

Below every competitor's flagship Pro — by 75%.



What this funds

- Free: 10 coach calls/day on Haiku 4.5. Full curriculum.
- Pro \$2.99: Plaid, statement upload, all calculators, scenarios, credit tracker, 40 coach calls/day.
- Pro+ \$6.99: 80 coach calls/day, Claude Sonnet 4.6 (50/mo cap then Haiku fallback), 1,200/mo.
- Annual: Pro \$24.99 (saves 31%) · Pro+ \$57.99 (saves 31%).
- \$19 one-time IAP: Patet Certified credential with LinkedIn add-to-profile.
- Boost packs: +50 calls \$1.99 · +200 calls \$4.99.

Plaid powers half of Patet's product surface. Removing it would gut Pro.

Plaid-dependent features

- Bank-account linking via Plaid Link (MFA-gated client + server)
- Transaction sync (Transactions product, 90-day history + ongoing webhooks)
- Liabilities sync (credit cards, student loans, mortgages, auto loans)
- Spending-pattern detection (5 pattern types) -> ranked lesson recommendations
- Peer benchmarks (anonymized, $k \geq 20$ cohort minimum)
- Coach context: every AI coach turn has Plaid spending data injected into the system prompt
- Spending alert notifications (threshold + category-based, deep-linkable)
- Webhook real-time updates (ES256 JWT verified, request_body_sha256 claim verified)

Plaid posture

Products in use

Transactions, Liabilities · US country code only.

Security

Plaid access tokens encrypted at rest (AES-256-GCM, dual-write to *_encrypted columns, migration 017).

Access gate

MFA enforced before /api/plaid/link-token. Email-verified required. 5-min step-up window for Plaid Link replay.

Webhook verification

ES256 JWT signature, fetched per kid via webhookVerificationKeyGet, JWK->PEM via Node crypto, 5-min replay window.

Off-boarding

Bank disconnect calls Plaid itemRemove first, then deletes local row. CASCADE on account deletion.

We've already done the work most pre-seed startups skip.

Authentication

- TOTP MFA (AES-256-GCM secret · SHA-256-HMAC recovery codes · 10 codes, single-use)
- MFA enforced as a hard gate before Plaid Link (5-min step-up)
- Account lockout (DB-persisted, survives Render redeploys)
- JWT revocation by jti (migration 016)
- httpOnly + sameSite cookies on web; Bearer header on mobile

Governance & audit

- RBAC (user / support / admin) · system_audit_log table · per-session inventory
- NIST AI RMF-aligned audit on every AI coach turn
- Crisis detection: Unicode, homoglyph, l33tspeak normalization
- Input + output guardrails (prompt injection, role override, medical/legal/financial boundary checks)
- 1,043 tests across the stack (632 app · 411 server)

Data protection

- AES-256-GCM at rest on Plaid tokens, financial PII, MFA secrets
- Annual encryption-key rotation procedure documented (InfoSec section 7)
- Self-serve user data export (GET /api/auth/me/export, JSON, redactions enforced)
- Right-to-erasure: DELETE /api/auth/me · FK ON DELETE CASCADE across 30+ child tables
- Backups: Neon 7-day window, age out aligned with EDPB 06/2020

Policy library (LLC repo)

- Information Security Policy
- Access Control Policy (Plaid-evidence ready)
- Data Retention and Disposal Policy (added 2026-05-17 for Plaid IAM Q11)
- Privacy Policy live at plainlydigital.com/patet/privacy
- Plaid form answers reference packet (PLAID_FORM_ANSWERS.md)

Six-month roadmap, in order of confidence.

Now -> Month 1	Consumer launch	Patet ships strict-freemium to public (live as of 2026-05-16). RevenueCat entitlements + Plaid prod creds + Resend transactional email all wired this week. App Store + Play Store submission queued.
Month 1 -> 3	Affiliate revenue layer	11 affiliate partners across 7 categories (Self, SoFi, Marcus, YNAB, Fidelity, Discover, Ally, Chime, Wealthfront, Lemonade, Schwab). ROAS dashboard live at /api/admin/affiliate/roas. Per-partner conversion webhooks live.
Month 2 -> 6	Patet Certified	50-question final assessment shipped. \$19 one-time IAP via RevenueCat. LinkedIn add-to-profile URL helper. Vanity slug picker. Public verify endpoint. Credential as a B2B credential layer for community-college + NACFC coach licensing.
Month 3 -> 6	LATAM launch	Spanish lesson content shipped (machine-translated via Sonnet, native reviewer pass pending). 100% i18n parity test-enforced. Expansion candidates: Mexico, Colombia, Argentina.
Month 4 -> 6	B2B curriculum licensing	NACFC coach pilot (financial coaches license Patet curriculum for their clients). Community-college pilot. Employer benefits pilot via SHRM expo channel.
Month 6+	GCP migration	Move backend off Render onto Cloud Run + Cloud SQL. Cloud Build CI on push. Already migrated other Plainly Digital products; Patet is on the queue.



Thanks for partnering with us.

Plaid is the load-bearing partner in the most differentiated half of our product. We are building this slowly and carefully — security, governance, and customer trust first. Happy to walk through any specific area in more depth.

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